

FUTURE MATRIX 2026

Rules & Guidelines

1. Eligibility

- Open to students from **1st Year to Final Year**.
- Teams may include members from **different departments/disciplines**.
- **IEEE membership is not mandatory**.
- Participants must carry a valid **College/Student ID**.

2. Registration & Selection

- **No registration fee**.
- Teams will be shortlisted based on their submitted proposal.
- Submission must include:
 - o Project Title
 - o Project Abstract
 - o PPT — **maximum 6 slides**
 - o Real-world Problem Statement — **maximum 4,000 characters**
 - o Proposed Solution & Value Creation — **maximum 4,000 characters**
 - o Technologies/Frameworks Used
- Teams must verify all information before final submission.

3. Project Requirements

- This is a **Hardware Track Hackathon**.
- Projects must contain a significant hardware component.
- Teams are expected to develop and demonstrate a **functional prototype or proof of concept**.
- Software, AI, IoT, cloud, or other technologies may be integrated with the hardware solution.

4. Components & Facilities

- Teams must bring **all required components, laptops, tools, development boards, sensors, equipment, chargers, and project materials**.
- Organizers will provide **network/internet connectivity only**.
- Teams are advised to carry backup components and offline copies of essential software, libraries, and drivers.

5. Originality

- Projects must represent the team's genuine work.

- **Plagiarism is strictly prohibited.**
- Open-source tools, libraries, APIs, and standard modules may be used appropriately.
- Pre-existing work must not be falsely presented as work completed during the hackathon.
- Teams must be able to explain every major part of their implementation.

6. Safety

- Participants must follow all electrical, battery, mechanical, soldering, and equipment safety requirements.
- Unsafe or hazardous systems may be stopped by the organizers.
- Teams are responsible for ensuring the safe operation of their prototypes.

7. Hackathon Conduct

- Teams must follow the official schedule and attend all **mandatory checkpoints**.
- Professional behaviour and respect toward participants, judges, mentors, and organizers are mandatory.
- Teams are responsible for their own components, equipment, and belongings.

8. Evaluation

Final evaluation will be conducted by:

3 Internal Judges + 1 External Judge

Projects will be evaluated based on:

- Problem Relevance
- Innovation
- Technical Implementation
- Prototype Functionality
- Feasibility
- Real-World Impact
- Scalability
- Presentation & Demonstration
- Technical Understanding

9. Final Submission & Demo

- Teams must complete all required submissions before the announced deadline.
- A **working prototype demonstration** is expected.
- Teams must clearly explain the problem, solution, technologies, implementation, results, and impact.

- Judges may inspect the hardware and ask technical questions.

10. Intellectual Property

- Teams remain responsible for respecting third-party copyrights, patents, licenses, and intellectual property.
- Unless separately agreed in writing, participation does **not automatically transfer ownership** of a team's original project to the organizers.

11. Disqualification

Teams may be disqualified for:

- Plagiarism or false project ownership
- Providing false information
- Unsafe practices
- Misconduct or sabotage
- Unauthorized external development
- Serious violation of event rules
- Failure to attend mandatory checkpoints

12. Organizer & Jury Decision

- Decisions of the **judging panel and organizing committee shall be final**.
- Organizers may modify schedules or operational procedures when necessary.
- Participants must follow all official announcements and instructions.

Important

FUTURE MATRIX 2026 is a hardware innovation hackathon—not merely an idea-presentation competition.

Teams are expected to progress from:

Problem → Solution → Engineering → Hardware Prototype → Demonstration → Real-World Impact